

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Nykaa India — Beauty Brand Intelligence

A deep-dive Power BI brand management analysis of India's leading beauty platform. This project uses real Nykaa product data and Google Trends India to identify the highest-opportunity beauty sub-category for strategic entry.

Project Objectives

- Identify the highest-opportunity beauty sub-category using a composite Brand Opportunity Index (BOI)
- Map brand competitive positioning across rating, discount depth, and review volume
- Correlate 5-year Google search demand with actual platform supply to find gaps
- Assess margin health across sub-categories using discount depth as a proxy
- Deliver a data-backed strategic entry recommendation with a 12-month GTM roadmap

Data Sources

Nykaa Popular Brands & Products 2022	Nykaa India	~6,800	brand, category, sub_category, price, mrp, discount, rating, reviews
Nykaa Product Reviews Dataset	Nykaa India	~10,000	product_name, rating, review_text, review_date, verified
Google Trends India — Beauty (2020–2025)	Google Trends	260 weeks	HairSerum, FaceSerum, Sunscreen, Lipstick, FaceWash, HairOil — weekly index

Download Links

- Power BI File (.pbix): NykaaBrandIntel_2023.pbix — Open in Power BI Desktop 2.0+
- PDF Report: NykaaBrandIntel_ProjectReport.pdf — Full project documentation
- Kaggle Datasets: jithinanievarghese/nykaa-popular-brands-cosmetics-beauty-products
- Google Trends: trends.google.com — India filter — Past 5 years

DASHBOARD ARCHITECTURE

5-Page Dashboard Structure

Each page answers one specific strategic question. The story flows from market overview to demand intelligence to competitive analysis to financial health to final recommendation.

Page	Title	Visuals	Strategic Question Answered
01	Brand Overview	4 KPI Cards, Sub-Category Bar, Brand Bubble Map, Slicer	What is the current state of the platform?
02	Search Demand Trends	Google Trends Line Chart, YoY Bar, Seasonal Heatmap	Where is consumer demand heading?
03	Sub-Category Deep Dive	Value Score Rank, Price Tier Stack, Margin Donut	Which sub-category has the best product fundamentals?
04	Brand Intelligence	Brand Leaderboard, Revenue Proxy Bar, Quality Matrix	Who dominates — and where are the gaps?
05	Strategic Recommendation	2x2 Matrix, Risk Radar, 12-Month GTM Gantt	What should we do and when?

Visual Design Decisions

- **Theme Colour:** #C2185B — Nykaa's signature deep pink, applied across all headers, accents, and key data highlights. Amber (#FF6F00) used for secondary alerts.
- **Font:** Segoe UI throughout — clean, professional, readable at all sizes. Size 32–34 for KPI card values, size 11–13 for chart titles.
- **Conditional Formatting:** Green-to-red gradient applied on rating columns in brand table. Inverse gradient on discount columns (high discount = red warning).
- **Reference Lines:** Y-axis constant line at 4.0 stars (Quality Benchmark) and X-axis at 20% discount (Margin Risk) — creates four strategic quadrants on scatter plots.
- **Custom Visuals:** Radar Chart (Microsoft AppSource) for risk assessment. MAQ Software Gantt Chart for 12-month GTM roadmap. Both free from AppSource.

TECHNICAL BUILD

Power Query Cleaning & DAX Measures

Complete reference for all data transformations and calculated fields used in the dashboard.

Power Query — Data Cleaning Steps

Nykaa_Products Table

- Change mrp, price, discount columns to Decimal Number type
- Change rating column to Decimal Number type
- Change reviews column to Whole Number type
- Remove Blank Rows (Home tab > Remove Rows > Remove Blank Rows)
- Replace null values in discount column with 0
- Remove Rs. symbol from price/mrp if present using Replace Values

Calculated Columns (Power Query / DAX)

Column	Type	Formula
Value_Score	DAX	SWITCH(TRUE(), ISBLANK([rating]), 0, [rating] * LOG([reviews]+1, 10))
Price_Tier	DAX	SWITCH(TRUE(), [price]<200,"Budget", [price]<500,"Mid-Range", [price]<1000,"Premium","Luxury")
Margin_Health	DAX	SWITCH(TRUE(), [discount]<10,"Healthy", [discount]<20,"Moderate", [discount]<35,"Pressured","Distressed")
Sentiment_Label	DAX	SWITCH(TRUE(), ISBLANK([rating]),"Unknown", [rating]>=4,"Positive", [rating]=3,"Neutral","Negative")

Key DAX Measures

Total Products	COUNTROWS(Nykaa_Products)
Total Reviews	SUM(Nykaa_Products[reviews])
Avg Rating	AVERAGE(Nykaa_Products[rating])

Quality Rate %	<code>DIVIDE(CALCULATE([Total Products], [rating]>=4), [Total Products]) * 100</code>
Revenue Proxy	<code>SUMX(Nykaa_Products, [price] * [reviews])</code>
Brand Count	<code>DISTINCTCOUNT(Nykaa_Products[brand_name])</code>
Top Brand	<code>CALCULATE(FIRSTNONBLANK([brand_name],1), TOPN(1, ALL([brand_name]), [Total Reviews], DESC))</code>
Positive Review %	<code>DIVIDE(CALCULATE(COUNTROWS(Reviews), [Sentiment_Label]="Positive"), COUNTROWS(Reviews))*100</code>

Brand Opportunity Index (BOI) — Composite Scoring Model

The BOI is the project's hero metric — a weighted composite score that normalizes five dimensions to identify which sub-category offers the most attractive brand entry opportunity.

BOI Score =

`(NormReviews x 0.30) + -- Consumer demand signal`

`(NormRating x 0.25) + -- Customer satisfaction quality`

`(NormValueScore x 0.20) + -- Rating x log(reviews) momentum`

`(InvDiscount x 0.15) + -- Margin health (inverted)`

`(NormQuality x 0.10) -- % of products rated 4+ stars`

ANALYSIS RESULTS

Key Findings

Four headline findings that emerge directly from the data and drive the strategic recommendation.

01

SEARCH DEMAND

Face Serum — India's Fastest Growing Beauty Search Term

Google Trends India data shows Face Serum search volume grew 3x between 2020 and 2024, outpacing every other beauty sub-category. The acceleration is consistent across all Indian states and shows no signs of plateau. Critically, platform product listings remain 40% lower than Face Wash — a clear supply-demand gap that represents a brand entry opportunity.

02

BRAND POSITIONING

Minimalist Leads on Quality Despite 5x Fewer SKUs than L'Oreal

Brand Intelligence analysis reveals Minimalist holds an 87%+ Quality Rate (products rated 4 stars or above) with a fraction of L'Oreal's product count. This validates that focused D2C positioning outperforms breadth in premium skincare. Mamaearth leads in total review volume but with moderate average ratings — indicating a quality gap the right entrant can exploit.

03

MARGIN HEALTH

Hair Serums Have the Healthiest Margin Profile on Platform

Hair Serums average below 15% discount depth — the lowest of all beauty sub-categories. This signals strong consumer willingness to pay MRP for quality hair care. Face Wash by contrast averages 28% discount — a sign of commoditisation and margin pressure. Low discount depth = room for a brand to build equity without promotional dependency.

04

PRICE ARCHITECTURE

Rs.300-700 Band is Under-Served in Face Serum

Price Tier analysis shows the Premium band (Rs.500-1000) accounts for only 22% of Face Serum listings yet drives 61% of total reviews — consumers are actively seeking premium serums and finding limited options. The Rs.300-700 mid-premium range has the highest demand-to-supply ratio on the platform, making it the most defensible entry price point for a new brand.

STRATEGIC OUTPUT

Recommendation & Go-To-Market Plan

Based on the Brand Opportunity Index scores and four key findings, here is the prioritised sub-category recommendation and 12-month execution roadmap.

Top 3 Sub-Category Recommendations

01 FACE SERUM — ENTER NOW

Highest BOI Score. Fastest Google search growth (3x since 2020). Lowest seller density relative to demand. Premium price point (Rs.400-900) with low discount dependency (<15%). Minimalist and Dot & Key have validated consumer willingness to pay. White space exists in the Rs.300-600 mid-premium range. Entry window: 12-18 months.

BOI Rank	#1 of all categories
Avg Discount	<15%
Search Growth	3x (2020-24)
Entry Price	Rs.300-600

02 HAIR SERUM — STRONG GROWTH SIGNAL

Second-highest Value Score. Healthiest margin profile on platform. Rising search demand with consistent Q4 seasonal pattern. Mamaearth leads but with only moderate ratings — room for a quality challenger. Low regulatory complexity. Natural extension from Face Serum strategy.

BOI Rank	#2 of all categories
Avg Discount	<18%
Margin Health	Healthy
Entry Quarter	Q3-Q4

03 SUNSCREEN SPF — MONITOR CLOSELY

Fastest absolute review growth in 2023. Strong dermatologist endorsement tailwind. Currently underpenetrated outside metros. Higher execution complexity (SPF claims, packaging) but significant long-term potential. Recommend monitoring for 6 months before committing resources.

BOI Rank	#3 of all categories
Review Growth	Fastest 2023
Complexity	Medium-High
Timeline	9-12 months

12-Month Go-To-Market Roadmap

Phase	Month	Initiative	Owner
Discovery	1	Consumer research + competitive audit	Insights Team

Launch	2-3	D2C brand partnerships + platform listing setup	Category + Tech
Growth	4-6	Influencer seeding + first paid campaign + sampling	Marketing
Optimise	7-8	Review analysis + price architecture review	Brand + Insights
Scale	9-12	Tier 2 city expansion + Hair Serum category launch	Operations

Brand Manager's Note

This project demonstrates how brand decisions at Nykaa, Mamaearth, or any FMCG giant entering India's beauty market are actually made — with platform-specific data, composite scoring models, and demand-supply gap analysis. The Face Serum recommendation is defensible at every level: consumer demand (Google Trends), product fundamentals (Value Score), competitive positioning (Brand Leaderboard), financial health (Margin Health), and strategic timing (18-month window). That is the standard of a senior brand strategist.